Sofia's Practice Toolkit

The 15-week plan to the Winter Showcase · Sep 28 → Fri Jan 8, 2027 (show day to be confirmed)

Glass House Dance · Team PITCH
Solo · Trio · 2026–27

Four parts, one goal

Each part has a different job. Don't skip ahead. Ms. Brittany: **memorize first, then improve the moves and tricks.**

1
Own it
Weeks 1–6 · Sep 28–Nov 8

Know every step with **no video and no one to follow**. Solo: Hannah's two videos, step by step, copying arms, feet, head and eyes. A teacher's new correction: **use it right away**. Knees over toes.

2
Clean it
Weeks 7–9 · Nov 9–Nov 29

Feet, knees, arms, eyes. **One fix at a time:** on to the next once it shows on **two videos in a row**. Trick preps look like dancing. Thanksgiving week: the 15-minute memory run.

3
Perform it
Weeks 10–14 · Nov 30–Jan 3

Focal points, stamina, costume on. **One full-out every session**, two back to back on Sundays. 2–3 mini audiences. Hold every ending.

4
Taper
Week 15 · Jan 4–8

Fewer runs from Dec 28, still one full-out. One run a day. Nothing new. No deep stretching. Night before: memory run only. Sleep. **Show day Fri Jan 8 (most likely)!**

Big checkpoints

Sat Oct 31	Whole **trio**, no video, nobody marking	☐
Sun Nov 1	Whole **solo** from memory, on the music	☐
Next solo rehearsal	Show Ms. Brittany: no missed steps	☐
Sun Nov 29	Every solo fix checked on page 4	☐
Sun Dec 6	Mini audience #1: grandparents on a video call	☐
Sun Dec 20	Costume run #1 on the taped-out stage · mini audience #2	☐
Sun Dec 27	Mini audience #3: a friend or two (costume run #2 the week after)	☐
Sat Jan 2	Mandatory rehearsal: back from break!	☐
Wed Jan 6	Mini show for the family	☐
Thu Jan 7	Night before: memory run only, early bed	☐
Fri Jan 8	**Winter Showcase** ★ (day to be confirmed)	☐

My week

Mon	Ballet · Acro · Jazz Tech at the studio. **At home: Hannah's videos + the solo in your head in the car.** No dancing.
Tue	Hip Hop · Ballroom. **15-minute memory run.**
Wed	Contemporary · solo rehearsal with Ms. Brittany when booked · **15-minute memory run**
Thu	HOME: strong + bendy + trio section + solo
Fri	HOME: technique + this week's trick + solo
Sat	Co Tech · PITCH rehearsal + the **15-minute memory run**
Sun	HOME: FILM the solo + trio section + film review

Trio privates with Larisa 1–2× a month. Home sessions are 35–40 minutes; from Nov 9 each one ends with **Show in your head** (page 3). **Never more than 2 days without the solo:** on a class, rehearsal or make-up day, the 15-minute memory run (Monday: Hannah's videos).

After the Showcase

Press Play Jan 15–17 (classes only) → Hollywood Connection Jan 22–24 → Ryze Feb 19–21 → iD Feb 26–28 → Gravit8 Mar 12–14 → Hollywood Vibe Apr 30–May 2 → Showstopper May 14–16 → Glass House Ball Jun 19–20. Then the plan restarts: own it, clean it, perform it, in shorter loops between comps.

Point. Straighten. Eyes up. Long arms. Hit the beat. Hold the end.

My 15-week tracker

A sticker when the app says ☆ Plan done. Sunday: write your ONE fix for next week. Home days: **Thu · Fri · Sun**

Wk	Solo goal	Thu	Fri	Sun	Full week ★	My one fix	←
1 **Sep 28**	**Own it:** 0:00–0:48 from memory	Oct 1	2	4	☆		
2 **Oct 5**	0:48–2:04 from memory	8	9	11	☆		
3 **Oct 12**	Hannah's video 1, step by step	15	16	18	☆		
4 **Oct 19**	Hannah's video 2, step by step	22	23	25	☆		
5 **Oct 26**	Whole solo from memory, on the counts	29	30	Nov 1	☆		
6 **Nov 2**	Whole solo ×2, no stops · show Ms. Brittany	5	6	8	☆		
7 **Nov 9**	**Clean it:** point + straighten · side leg: pick one	12	13	15	☆		
8 **Nov 16**	Long arms · high passé · trick preps are dancing	19	20	22	☆		
9 **Nov 23**	Light week: the 15-minute memory run only	26	27	29	☆		
10 **Nov 30**	**Perform it:** donut roll · focal points · mini audience #1	3	4	6	☆		
11 **Dec 7**	Two full-outs back to back (Sunday)	10	11	13	☆		
12 **Dec 14**	Full run in costume · tape out the stage · mini audience #2	17	18	20	☆		
13 **Dec 21**	Hold the ending to 2:00 · mini audience #3	24	25	27	☆		
14 **Dec 28**	Costume run #2 · fewer runs · sleep 9–12 h	31	Jan 1	3	☆		
15 **Jan 4**	**Taper:** one run a day · mini show Wed · SHOW Fri Jan 8	7 memory run	8 ☆ **SHOW**		☆		

Sticker rule. A sticker when the app says ☆ Plan done. **3 in a week = full week ★**: a big sticker in the star box. Every ☆ on the next page: pick a reward with Mom. **The arrow:** tape it to a paper clip; Mom moves it down a row on Sunday. **A new correction?** practise it right away.

← **THIS WEEK**

75 days to the show

Cross off each day at bedtime · the number = days to go · ☆ = pick a reward with Mom Mon Oct 26 → Fri Jan 8

Week	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun · review
Wk 5 Oct 26	26 74	27 73	28 72	29 71	30 70	31 ☆ **69**	Nov 1 ☆ **68**
Wk 6 Nov 2	2 67	3 66	4 65	5 64	6 63	7 62	8 61
Wk 7 Nov 9	9 60	10 59	11 58	12 57	13 56	14 55	15 54
Wk 8 Nov 16	16 53	17 52	18 51	19 50	20 49	21 48	22 47
Wk 9 Nov 23	23 46	24 45	25 44	26 43	27 42	28 41	29 ☆ **40**
Wk 10 Nov 30	30 39	Dec 1 38	2 37	3 36	4 35	5 34	6 ☆ **33**
Wk 11 Dec 7	7 32	8 31	9 30	10 29	11 28	12 27	13 26
Wk 12 Dec 14	14 25	15 24	16 23	17 22	18 21	19 20	20 ☆ **19**
Wk 13 Dec 21	21 18	22 17	23 16	24 15	25 14	26 13	27 ☆ **12**
Wk 14 Dec 28	28 11	29 10	30 9	31 8	Jan 1 7	2 ☆ **6**	3 5
Wk 15 Jan 4	4 4	5 3	6 ☆ **2**	7 1	8 ☆ **SHOW**		

My rewards · at every ☆ pick one with Mom: a movie night, a scrunchie, Saturday breakfast…

☆ **Sat Oct 31** · Whole trio, no video

My reward: _____

☆ **Sun Nov 1** · Whole solo from memory, on the music

My reward: _____

☆ **Next solo rehearsal** · Show Ms. Brittany: no missed steps

My reward: _____

☆ **Sun Nov 29** · Every solo fix clean on two videos in a row

My reward: _____

☆ **Sun Dec 6** · Mini audience #1: grandparents on a video call

My reward: _____

☆ **Sun Dec 20** · Costume run #1 on the taped-out stage

My reward: _____

☆ **Sun Dec 20** · Mini audience #2

My reward: _____

☆ **Sun Dec 27** · Mini audience #3: one run for a friend or two

My reward: _____

☆ **Sat Jan 2** · Mandatory rehearsal, back from break

My reward: _____

☆ **Wed Jan 6** · Family mini show

My reward: _____

☆ **Fri Jan 8** · Winter Showcase ★

My reward: _____

☆ **After the show** · We celebrate with…

My reward: _____

My week

This one is yours: draw it, colour it, sticker it. What does each day look like?

Sofia's week
2026–27

Monday

Tuesday

Wednesday

Thursday

Friday

Saturday

Sunday

How to practice at home

The best way to get better between classes: short, often, one thing at a time

For Sofia
and her grown-up

The home session · 35–40 minutes

5 min	**Warm up.** Jumping jacks, arm circles, leg swings, light jog. Always first.
8 min	**Strong.** Hollow hold + superman 3×20s · plank + side plank 2×20–30s · slow relevés 2×15 · one-leg balance 20s · lying leg lifts 2×10.
7 min	**Bendy**, after warm-up only. Right, left, middle split + straddle, 20–30s each. A stretch, never pain.
5 min	**Knees + technique.** Pliés in 1st and 2nd facing the mirror 2×8, knees over toes. Slow lunges 2×5 each side. Relevés. Tricks wait until the solo is memorized.
10 min	**The dances.** Trio: this week's section (page 5). Solo: until Nov 9 from the top as far as you know; from Nov 9 **one full-out**, eyes up (two back to back on Sundays from Nov 30). Until Nov 29: **film one chunk**, watch it when you want, try again.
6 min	**Show in your head** FROM NOV 9 The script on the right.

Monday at home: Hannah's videos and the solo in your head in the car, no dancing after three classes. Tue, Wed, Sat, a rehearsal or make-up day, the light week (Nov 23) and the night before the show: the **15-minute memory run** instead. Never more than 2 days without the solo.

Learn it so it sticks

1. **One chunk.** Solo: use **Hannah's two videos**. Watch one 8-count, pause, do it, then go on to the next 8.
2. **Slow.** Do it at half speed 3×, copying arms, feet, head and eyes right from the start. The app practice player can slow the music to 75%.
3. **Music.** Do it with the real music.
4. **No help.** Turn away from the video and the mirror. Do it alone.
5. **Say it.** Say the move names out loud while you mark. Words are a second memory.
6. **Chain it.** Add the chunk to the one before it, then run both.
7. **Pause-and-predict.** Ask a grown-up to pause the video anywhere: you say and show what comes next. When you never have to guess, the step is learned.
8. **From the top.** Every session: start at the beginning, go as far as you know, then add ONE new chunk.

Set up a dance spot

- ☐ Clear space, with the mat out for anything upside down
- ☐ Tape an **X** on the floor for "center front"
- ☐ A sticker on the wall = **the judges**. Dance to it.
- ☐ Phone on a stand at the **side** for filming
- ☐ Music ready on the app: the real track for each dance
- ☐ Water bottle, hair up, socks off for floor work
- ☐ Once in December: **tape out the stage size** for a costume run

Grown-up's job

- **Be the stage crew**, not the teacher: music, timer, filming, stickers.
- Ask, don't correct: "What comes next?" "Where do your eyes go?" "Which fix are you working on?"
- Keep corrections to what the teachers gave. A teacher's new one goes into practice **right away**. If something looks off, write it under *Questions for my teachers*.
- **Video:** let Sofia choose when to watch her clips. Every review starts with what went well.
- Praise the work: "You kept your eyes up the whole time," not "you're so talented."
- Start at the same time each practice day. A routine beats willpower.

Show in your head FROM NOV 9

1. Stand in your opening pose, in your dance clothes.
2. Play the real song, full speed.
3. Close your eyes. See the stage, the lights, the judges' table.
4. Dance it in your head through your own eyes; let your arms and head mark small.
5. Feel the story. Slow, calm breaths.
6. Hold the ending until the very last note.
7. Do it 2–3 times. The last time, watch yourself from the audience.

A grown-up reads the steps out loud for the first two weeks. Picturing it at bedtime is extra and optional: never let it push bedtime later.

Safety rules

- Warm up before stretching. No oversplits, no forcing.
- Acro only on the mat or with a spotter. Kick-overs and aerials only in class.
- If it hurts, stop and tell a grown-up.
- Stop before tired. Tired teaches the wrong way.
- **Sleep 9–12 hours**, same bedtime every night.

★ Solo · Stay a Little Longer

Lyrical · choreography Hannah · rehearsals with Ms. Brittany when booked · 2:04 track

Soft 0:00–0:48
Full 0:48–1:52 · fade

Where the moves land · checked Oct 25 · photos on the cue cards

START	MOVE	I LOOK AT...
0:00	Opening walk, tendus, arm reach	
0:07	Drop to the floor, sit	
0:10.5	**★ Side-sit leg reach**	
0:12.5	Slide out long, curl, kneeling arms	
0:16.5	**★ Kneeling arch, tip onto hands, leg kicks up**	
0:19.5	Side roll, long stretch	
0:22	Rise, travel, arms up	
0:31.5	**★ Heel stretch, leg held high**	
0:34	Deep lunge · hands behind head · run, kicks	
0:43.75	Gather: fold, V arms, run-up	
0:48	**★ LEAP on the swell**	
0:49.5	**★ Cartwheel**	
0:52	High kick, turns, lunges, arms	
1:07.75	**★ Walkover to knees** (handstand, bridge, knees)	
1:10.5	Kneeling arms, kneeling leg kick	
1:17	Run to the mat	
1:18.25	**★ Donut roll on the mat**	
1:21	Traveling, passé on the mat	
1:28.5	**★ Handstand**, split legs, step down to sit	
1:30.5	Floor section, straddle at 1:38	
1:40.75	**★ Floor kick**	
1:42.5	Rise, turn + kick, drop, lunge up	
1:49.5	**★ Passé turns**, arms overhead	
1:53	V arms, lower to sit	
1:57.5	Seated leg lift	
2:00.5	**★ Floor ending:** curl on your side, hold	

My fixes · one at a time · check when the teacher says "yes"

Done on video = it shows on two videos in a row. Then the teacher checks it.

- ☐ **Knees over toes** in every plié, lunge, landing and floor entry. No knees falling in. *(Ms. Brittany, Oct 13)*
- ☐ **Point + straighten** on every floor extension, even as the leg comes down
- ☐ **Side leg: pick one.** A clean attitude or straight. Never halfway.
- ☐ **Eyes up.** No mirror, no teacher. Every section has a spot.
- ☐ **Long arms.** Elbows straight overhead, shoulders down.
- ☐ **Passé high.** Toe beside the knee, high relevé, sharp spot.
- ☐ **Trick prep is dancing.** Head stays up until the hands go down.
- ☐ **Donut roll:** arms down, head ALL the way back. Don't tuck the chin. *(Hannah)*
- ☐ **Hold the ending** until 2:00, when the sound is gone.

Trick ladder · starts Nov 9, after the solo is memorized

Check **Can do** (alone), **Clean ×3** (3 in a row), **In the dance** (on the beat in a full run).

TRICK	THE DRILL	CAN DO	CLEAN ×3	IN THE DANCE
1 · Side-sit leg reach 0:10.5	Sit on one hip, hand on the floor. Leg straight up: 4 counts up, hold 2, 4 down. 6 each side. Arm slides up the leg. "*Push the floor, reach the toe.*"	☐	☐	☐
2 · Heel stretch 0:31.5	Développé side at a counter: 4 up, hold 2, 4 down ×6. Side-lying leg lifts 2×12. Standing heel down.	☐	☐	☐
3 · Leap + cartwheel 0:48 · 0:49.5	Leap ON the swell, then cartwheel: reach, look, place. Cartwheel over a tape line, legs straight. Play from 0:44 ×5.	☐	☐	☐
4 · Walkover to knees 1:07.75 + handstand 1:28.5	Wrists first. Wall handstand 3×10–15s. Kick up to vertical ×5, split at the top ×5. Kick-overs and aerials only in class.	☐	☐	☐
5 · Floor kick 1:40.75	8 slow kicks each side, 4 up, 4 down, pointed at the top. Kick from the hip, back long.	☐	☐	☐
6 · Passé turns 1:49.5	Passé balance on relevé 10s. Quarter ×8, half ×8, singles ×10. Spot a sticker.	☐	☐	☐
7 · The ending 2:00.5	Last 15 seconds of the real track ×5. Hold, breathe, count 8 more after you think it's over.	☐	☐	☐
8 · Donut roll 1:18.25	Mat only. Cobra + seal 20s first. Kneeling backbend, hands to heels 3×5s; bridge holds 3×10s. Then the donut shape: arms down, knees bent, chest open, head ALL the way back. Don't tuck the chin (Hannah).	☐	☐	☐

★ Trio · Enjoy the Silence

Contemporary · choreography + teacher Larisa · with Hannah and Lauren · 2:17 slow cover, ~86 BPM

Larisa's rule: memorize first, clean in privates

Memory map

Video → with music → no help. Check a box only when it runs clean **twice**. One section per Thursday and Sunday (see the tracker).

TIME	SECTION	VIDEO	MUSIC	NO HELP ✓✓
0:00	Kneeling opening	☐	☐	☐
0:02	Lunges: back leg long and pointed	☐	☐	☐
0:04	Floor phrase: leg extensions + shoulder stand	☐	☐	☐
0:22	Kneeling STILLNESS: one shared focus	☐	☐	☐
0:28	Low crawl, arabesque on knees, seated extensions	☐	☐	☐
0:42	Rise + traveling CANON: know YOUR start count	☐	☐	☐
1:04	Runs + lunges (Lauren's acro)	☐	☐	☐
1:12	Arms-up phrase → lunges down to the floor	☐	☐	☐
1:36	THREE BRIDGES → lying	☐	☐	☐
1:50	Traveling triangle	☐	☐	☐
2:06	Ending: three-level floor picture, hold past 2:12	☐	☐	☐
WHOLE DANCE: no video, nobody marking · goal Sat Oct 31				☐

Fixes for the privates

- ☐ **Eyes:** no mirror at 0:02. In the 0:22 stillness all three eyelines agree.
- ☐ **Arabesque on knees (0:30):** match the agreed height, lock the knee.
- ☐ **Canon waiting (0:52–0:58):** hold a SHAPE with intent. Never stand "off."
- ☐ **Arms overhead (0:58):** straight, not hands to the head. Match Hannah's line.
- ☐ **Upstage = bigger.** When I'm farthest from the judges, I dance bigger.
- ☐ **Match Lauren's size.** She dances the biggest.

Already strong: shoulder stand (cleanest of the three), lunge at 0:02, bridge at 1:36, full-out runs.

The music won't help, so we do

The song stays almost the same volume until a small lift at 1:32 and fades at 2:12. The **three of you** make the big and small moments with stillness against speed.

Home trick: the canon is the hardest part. Fill in the count sheet below for 0:42–1:04 with Larisa or from the video, then **say your counts out loud** while you mark.

Canon count sheet · 0:42–1:04

Write a move name (or a doodle) in each count box. Star the count where YOU start.

8#	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1								
2								
3								
4								

This week

Week # ____ · Week of _____ · Print a new page every week

Fill in Sunday after the film review

Thursday · strong + bendy + trio

- ☐ Warm up 5 min
- ☐ Strong 8 min
- ☐ Bendy 7 min
- ☐ TRIO section: _____ (video → music → no help)
- ☐ Solo: from the top (from Nov 9: one full-out)
- ☐ Film one chunk, watch it, try again (until Nov 29)
- ☐ Show in your head 6 min (from Nov 9)

Friday · technique + trick

- ☐ Warm up 5 min
- ☐ Passé balances, pirouettes, kicks
- ☐ Trick: _____ (until Nov 9: knees over toes drills)
- ☐ Solo: from the top (from Nov 9: one full-out), eyes up
- ☐ Film one chunk, watch it, try again (until Nov 29)
- ☐ Show in your head 6 min (from Nov 9)

Sunday · film it

- ☐ Warm up 5 min
- ☐ Solo full out, FILMED from the side (from Nov 30: two back to back)
- ☐ Send the video to the app Coach
- ☐ TRIO section: _____
- ☐ Light stretch
- ☐ Show in your head 6 min (from Nov 9)
- ☐ Film review (right) →

Before every run, say it

Point. Straighten. Eyes up. Long arms. Hit the beat. Hold the end.

Missed 2 days? Today is the 15-minute memory run.

Sunday film review

Watch once with a grown-up. **Start with what went well.** Then write:

One thing I loved

One fix for next week (only one!)

This week's fix on the video? ☐ yes ☐ not yet (two yeses in a row → the next fix)

Best today: ☐ feet ☐ knees ☐ eyes ☐ arms

Did I hold the ending until the music stopped? ☐ yes ☐ not yet

Missed or mixed-up steps? Where: _____

App Coach said: ☐ same as my teacher ☐ something new (ask Ms. Brittany first)

What my teachers said this week

Ms. Brittany · Larisa · Isadora · Hannah. Star Ms. Brittany's top 3. New ones go into practice right away.

Questions for my teachers

How I feel about my dances

Solo: hard · okay · good · great **Trio:** hard · okay · good · great

Circle one. A "hard" week is a good week to tell Mom what feels hard.

Trio private with Larisa (if this week)

DATE	WHAT LARISA FIXED	PRACTICE THIS AT HOME